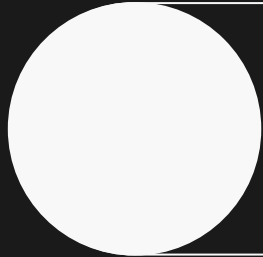


Google Ads for Beginners



Susan Wenograd

The journey of this course

Objective 1

Confidently Navigate the Google Ads Interface

Basic Settings, Ad
Options, and
Account Structure



Objective 2

How to Do Keyword Research

Discover methods for
structuring Ad Groups
and Ad Copy



Objective 3

Understand How the Ads Auction Works

Learn Different
Campaign Types &
Bidding Options

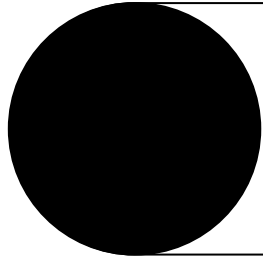


Objective 4

Learn the Tools and Reports to Help Optimize Your Results

Lesson 1: The Google Ads Interface

Course Objective 1: Confidently Navigate the Google Ads Interface



Susan Wenograd

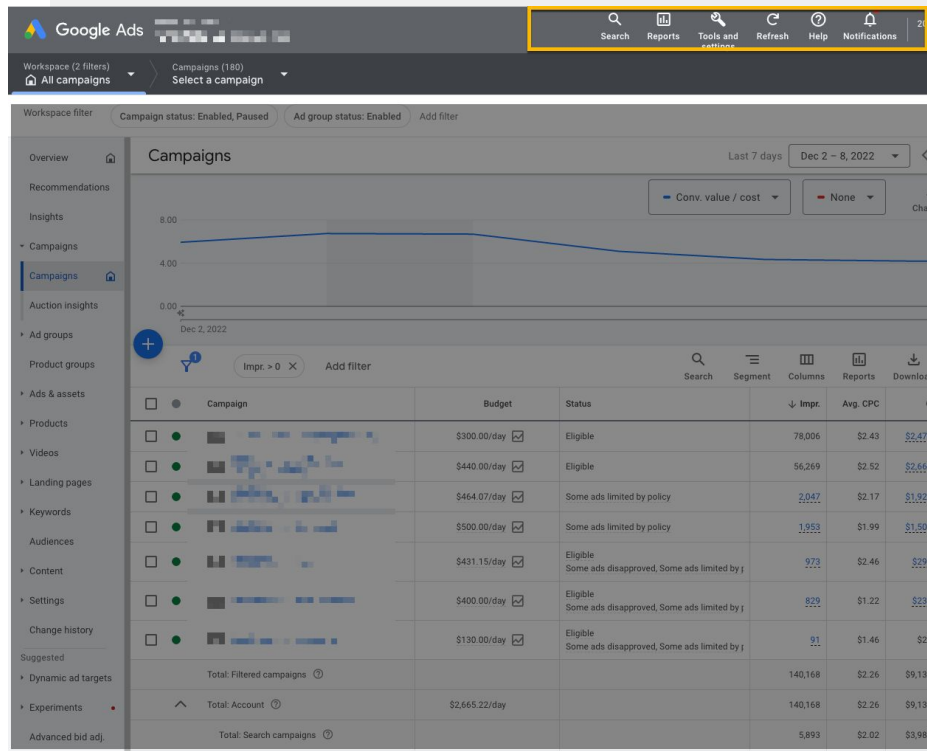
Lesson Objectives

1. Get familiar with the Google Ads Interface

Account Tools

Top-line menu contains overall account management tools:

- Billing
- Reports
- Conversion Tracking
- Account-wide Tools

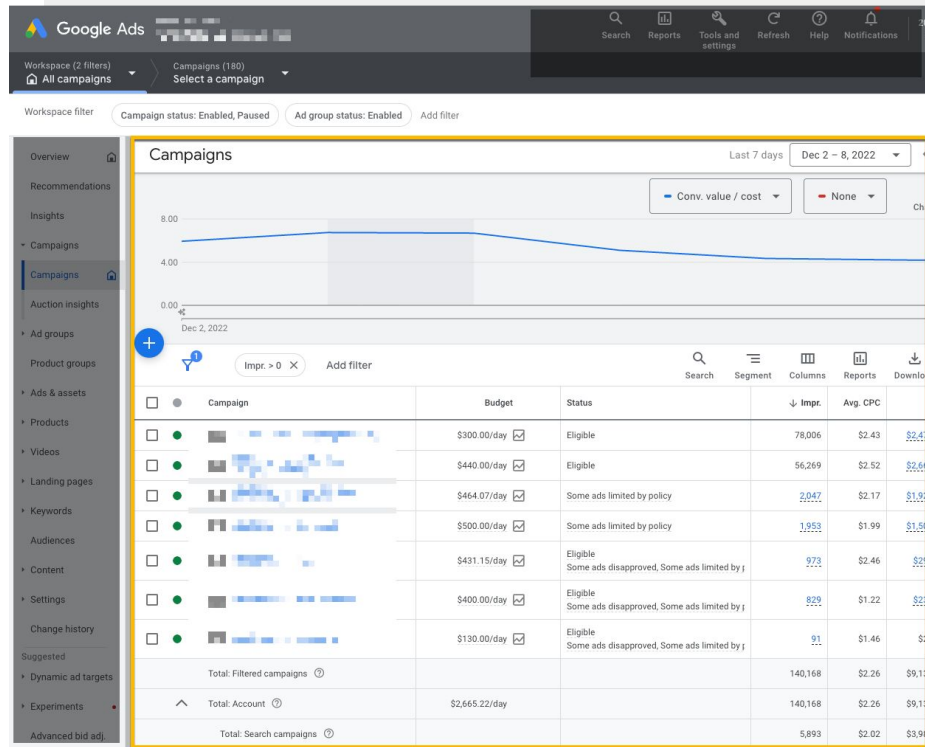


Campaign Performance

Central panel contains campaign performance information.

You can view different data ranges by changing the date in the upper right.

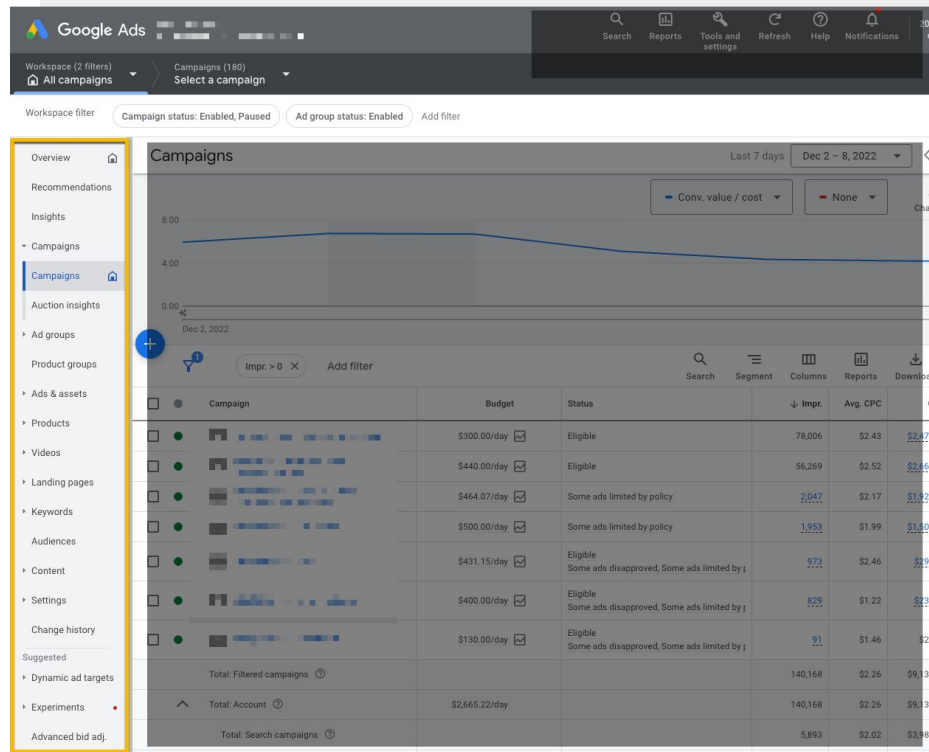
Clicking on a campaign will take you to the ad groups in it.



Campaign Tools

The left panel contains navigation to settings/setups for your Campaigns, Ad Groups, etc.

Most of these have dropdowns within them to drill down further. We will explore these later.

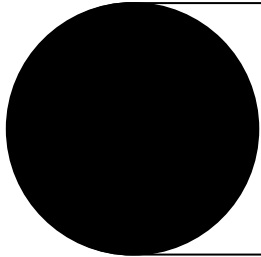


Lesson Recap

1. There are three main areas that house everything for Google Ads:
 - a. The main navigation takes you to settings that apply to the account as a whole.
 - b. The left hand navigation will let you drill down and navigate to different interfaces containing data about your campaigns.
 - c. The main middle area displays the data, filtered what the choices you made in the left hand navigation.

Lesson 2: Setting Up Conversions

Course Objective 1: Confidently Navigate the Google Ads Interface



Susan Wenograd

Lesson Objectives

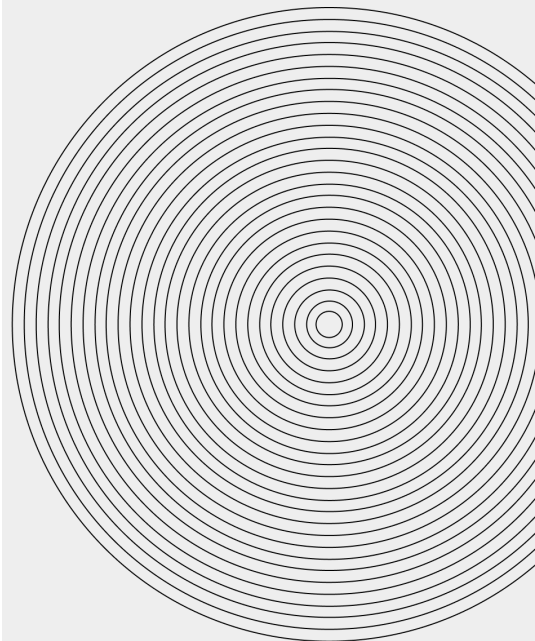
1. Understand the two main ways to measure conversions.
2. Walk through how to set up each type.
3. See the difference between the two methods.

Before you launch anything...

Your tracking must be on point.

Two main ways to measure conversions

Here's how you choose



Where Conversions Live

732 ▾

Search Reports **1** Tools and settings Refresh Help Notifications 205-486-7693 C client@susanv

Planning	Shared Library	Bulk Actions	Measurement	Setup	Billing
Performance Planner	Audience manager	All bulk actions	2 Conversions	Business data	Summary
Keyword Planner	Bid strategies	Rules	Customer value	Policy manager	Transactions
Reach Planner	Negative keyword lists	Scripts	Google Analytics	Access and security	Documents
Ad Preview and Diagnosis	Shared budgets	Uploads	Attribution	Linked accounts	Promotions
App advertising hub	Location groups		Lift measurement	Google tag	Settings
	Placement exclusion lists			Preferences	Advertiser verification
	Asset library			Google Merchant Center	
				Content suitability NEW	

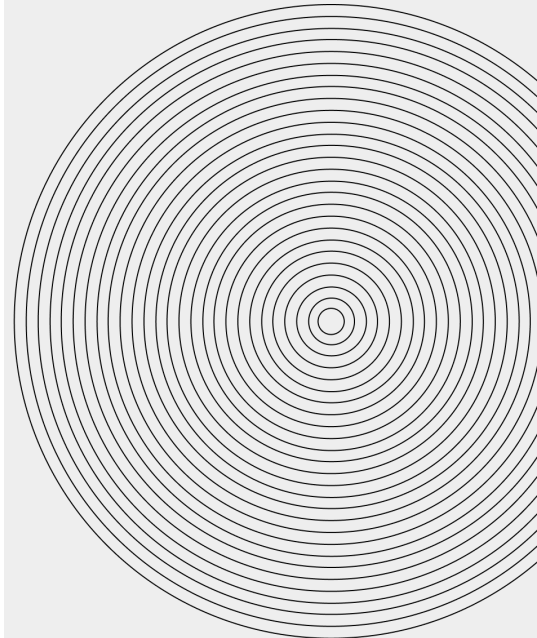
2 Ways to Count

Way #1: Import existing Goals from Google Analytics

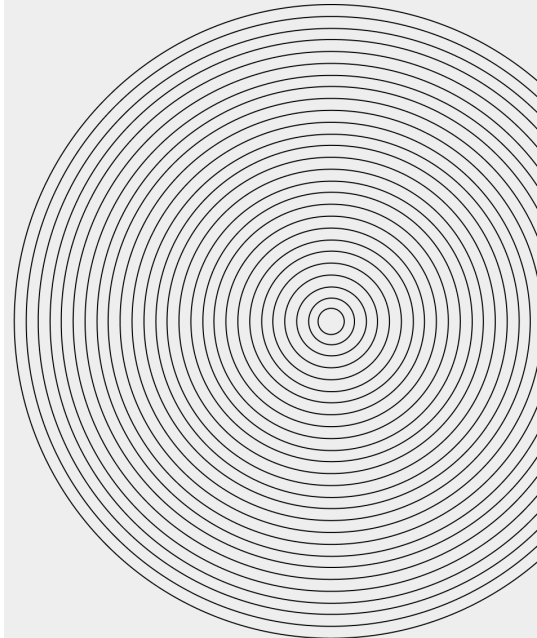
Way #2: Set up Conversion tagging from Google Ads

Purchases Account-default goal 180 of 180 campaigns					
☐ Conversion action	Action optimization ↓	Conversion source	All conv.	All conv. value	Status
☐ Transactions (Google Ads)	Primary	Website	447.65	72,390.00	Recording conversions
☐ Transactions (Analytics)	Secondary	Website (Google Analytics (UA))	324.38	50,533.03	Recording conversions

What do you see as the advantages of these approaches?



What drawbacks do you see with these options?



What's the Difference?

Google Analytics will default to your attribution settings in Google Analytics.

Pros: Your data will match what you see in Google Analytics.

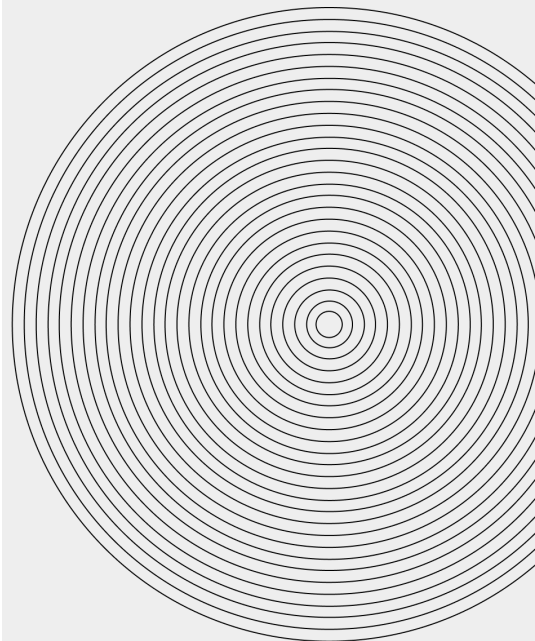
Cons: If you optimize to last-click, and this is your primary conversion focus in Google Ads, you might miss out on higher-funnel conversions.

Look Again At the Difference

Purchases Account-default goal 180 of 180 campaigns					
☐ Conversion action	Action optimization ↓	Conversion source	All conv.	All conv. value	Status
☐ Transactions (Google Ads)	Primary	Website	447.65	72,390.00	Recording conversions
☐ Transactions (Analytics)	Secondary	Website (Google Analytics (UA))	324.38	50,533.03	Recording conversions

Now You're Ready to Measure

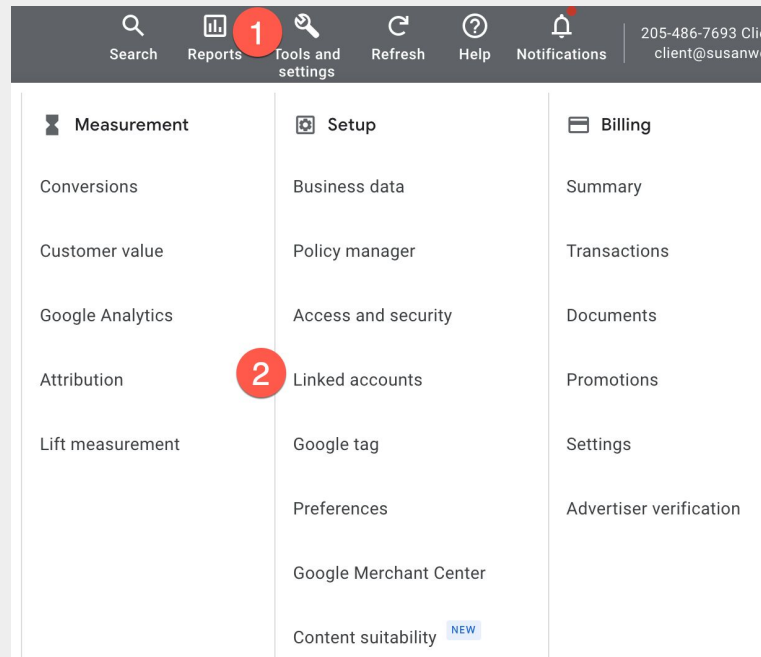
Here's how you implement each measurement option.



Importing Events

Use the same login for Google Ads over on Google Analytics.

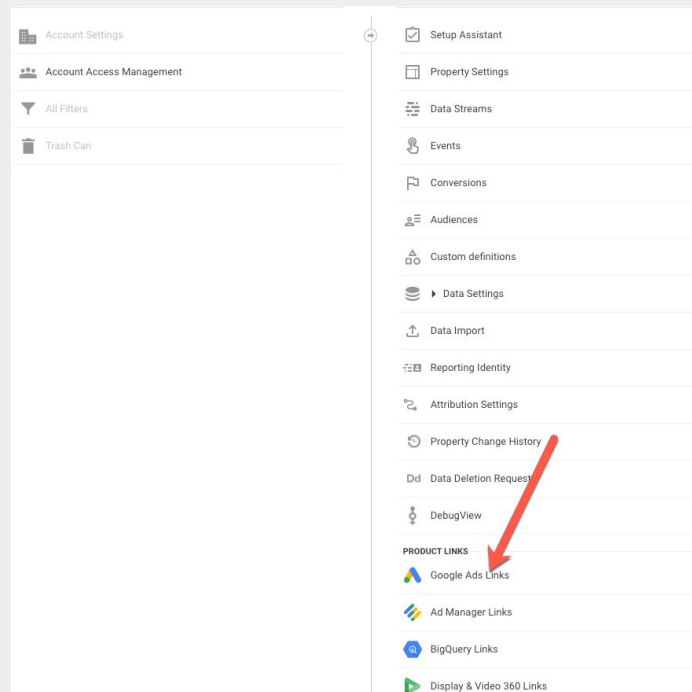
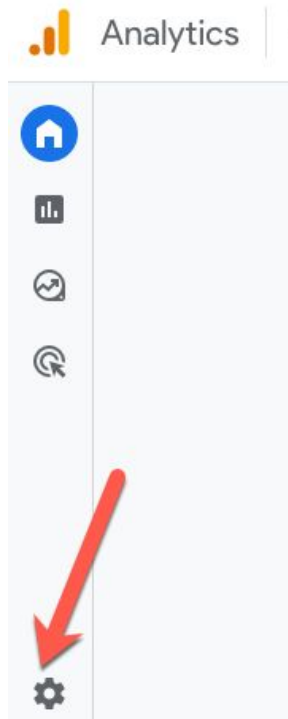
Make sure it has Read/Write Access.



Enable Both Ads & Analytics

Use the same login for Google Ads over on Google Analytics. This “links” the two so you can officially connect them.

Make sure it has Read/Write Access.



Using Google Ads Tag

Start tracking conversions

Conversion tracking is critical to successful online marketing. It lets you see what people do - the conversion actions they take - after seeing your ad. You set up one conversion action at a time, but you can track multiple conversion actions at once. [Learn more](#)

Select the kind of conversions you want to track. ②

Website



Track actions on your website

App



Track actions on your app

Phone calls



Track calls from your ads or website

Import



Import data from Google Analytics or another source

Using Google Ads Tag

Enter the URL for the website where you want to measure your conversions

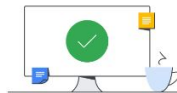
Scanning your website will determine if it's already set up to measure conversions. You can then measure conversions on your website.

Scan

Save and continue

Cancel

Create conversion actions automatically from website events



Set up conversion actions without code if you can identify events on your website to count as conversions, such as loading a thank you page or confirmation page.

Conversion goal	Event details
 Contact SUGGESTION	User lands on a URL that starts with www.shesbirdie.com/checkout/contact 🕒 Page load Accept suggestion ⋮
 Page view SUGGESTION	User lands on a URL that starts with www.shesbirdie.com/checkout/thank 🕒 Page load Accept suggestion ⋮
 Begin checkout SUGGESTION	User lands on a URL that starts with www.shesbirdie.com/checkout 🕒 Page load Accept suggestion ⋮

+ Add event

Create conversion actions manually using code



Set up conversion actions manually:

- If you use transaction specific values, transaction IDs, and/or other custom parameters.
- If you want to measure clicks on buttons or links.

If you choose this option, you will need to add an event snippet to your website code

+ Add a conversion action manually

Using Google Ads Tag

This allows you to fully tailor your conversion, if you would like.

When you save it, you will be given code to place on your site. It will not record or function until you do so.

 Conversion actions created manually need to be added to your website's code. When you're finished creating conversion actions, you'll get instructions for setting them up on your website

Goal and action optimization

Select the Goal category for this action

Select category

You can use these goals / categories to group your conversion actions and segment your campaign reports.

Conversion name

Enter a conversion name

0 / 100

Example: "June newsletter sign-ups", "Manager job applications", or "Big cookie sales"

Value

Measure the impact of your advertising by giving conversions a value

☐ Use the same value for each conversion

☐ Use different values for each conversion

☐ Don't use a value for this conversion action (not recommended)

Use same value if you're tracking leads, sign-ups, or page views.

Use different values if you sell multiple products at different prices and you'd like a unique value recorded for each conversion.

[Learn more](#)

Count

Select how many conversions to count per click or interaction

☒ Every

Recommended for purchases because every purchase is valuable.

☐ One

Recommended for leads, sign-ups, and other conversions because only the first interaction is valuable.

If someone clicks your ad and completes 2 separate purchases on different occasions, 2 conversions are recorded.

[Learn more](#)

Click-through conversion window

30 days

Engaged-view conversion window

3 days

View-through conversion window

1 day

Attribution model

Data-driven **Recommended**

Conversion Types

Primary Action optimization:

Used to calculate results, and in automated bidding decisions & calculations.

Secondary Action optimization:

Data for observation, but not used actively to do anything.

Conversion action	Action optimization ↓
Transactions (Google Ads)	<u>Primary</u>
Transactions (Analytics)	<u>Secondary</u>

Setting Campaign Conversions

When you create a new Search campaign, the Conversions you've set up will be available.

Use these conversion goals for campaign performance optimization

Conversion goals labeled as account default will use data from all of your campaigns to improve your bid strategy and campaign performance

Conversion Goals	Conversion Source	Conversion Actions	Value
 Engagements (account default)	Website	<u>3 actions</u>	Multiple values
 Page views (account default)	Website	 <u>1 action</u>	\$5.00
 Purchases (account default)	Website	<u>2 actions</u>	Dynamic (Multiple values avg)

Lesson Recap

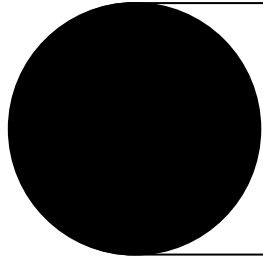
1. You can measure multiple conversion types.
2. You have two options for their measurement: import from Google Analytics, or set up Conversion tagging using a Google Ads pixel.
3. These have pros/cons, and there's no "right" way. Decide based on how you measure your marketing objectives overall.
4. We will see where these come into play during account setup.

Additional Resources

1. How to set up Conversions [if you use Tag Manager](#).
2. [Troubleshooting](#) your Conversion tracking.

Lesson 3: How Search Campaigns Are Made

Course Objective 1: Confidently Navigate the Google Ads Interface

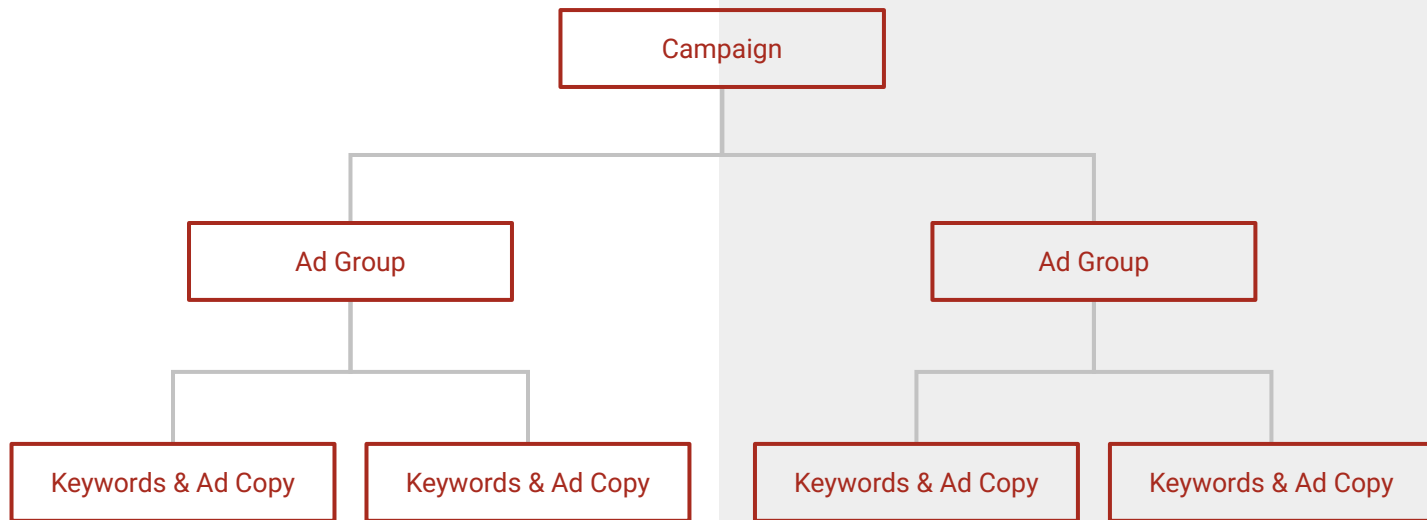


Susan Wenograd

Lesson Objectives

1. Review how accounts are structured with Campaigns, Ad Groups, Keywords and Ads.
2. Understand what settings live in which of those things.

Parent/Child Structure



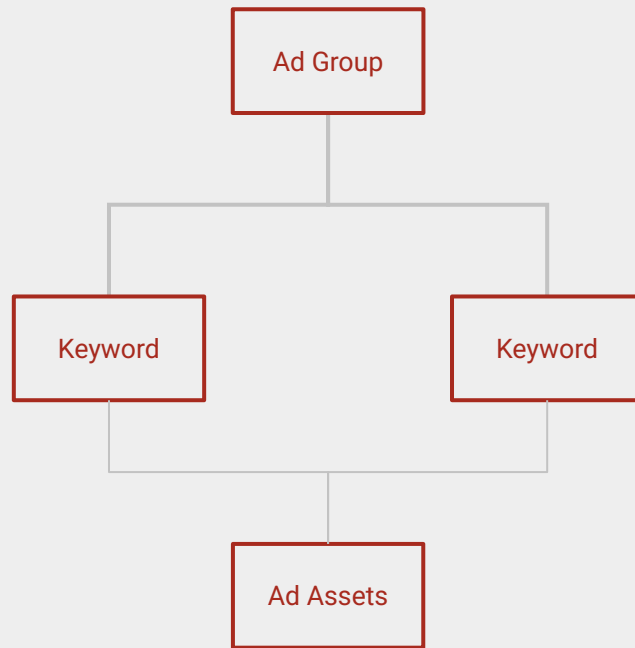
What Campaigns Do

- Budget
- Geotargeting
- Bidding methodology
- Conversions to use for results & bidding
- Settings for Dynamic Ads (we'll cover that later)
- Automatic asset creation settings
- Start/End Dates

Campaign name		▼
Goals	Using account goal settings	▼
Customer acquisition	Bid equally for new and existing customers	▼
Marketing Objective	No marketing objective selected	▼
Campaign status	● Enabled	▼
Networks	Google Search Network, Search partners	▼
Locations	Alabama, United States (state) + 50 more	▼
Languages	All languages	▼
Budget	\$500.00/day	▼
Bidding	Manual CPC Try Smart Bidding to optimize your campaign	▼
Automatically created assets	Off: Use only assets I provide directly for my ads	▼
Start and end dates	Start date: February 2, 2022 End date: Not set	▼

What Ad Groups Do

- Keyword groups that all share the same ad creative
- Bidding options
- Ad Rotation Settings



How Ad Creative Works

Headline Option 1

Headline Option 2

Headline Option 3

Description Option 1

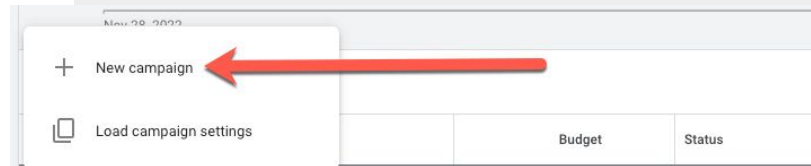
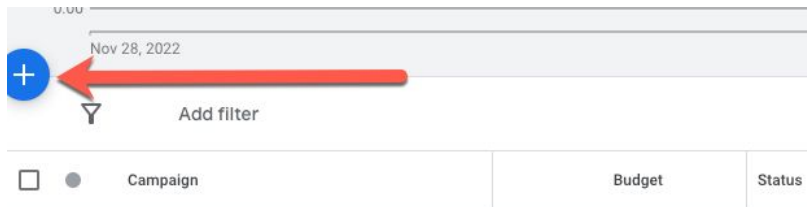
Description Option 2

Description Option 3

Description Option 4

Creating a Campaign

- Hit the + and then “New Campaign.”



Creating a Campaign

- Hit “Create campaign without a goal’s guidance.”
- This is the best way to have total control and understanding over the setup of your campaign.

Choose your objective

Select an objective to tailor your experience to the goals and settings that will work best for your campaign



Sales

Drive sales online, in app, by phone, or in store



Leads

Get leads and other conversions by encouraging customers to take action



Website traffic

Get the right people to visit your website



Product and brand consideration

Encourage people to explore your products or services



Brand awareness and reach

Reach a broad audience and build awareness



App promotion

Get more installs, engagement and pre-registration for your app



Local store visits and promotions

Drive visits to local stores, including restaurants and dealerships



Create a campaign without a goal's guidance

Choose a campaign type first, without a recommendation based on your objective.

Creating a Campaign

- Then hit “Search” for your campaign type

Select a campaign type

The screenshot displays the 'Select a campaign type' interface with eight campaign options arranged in a 2x4 grid. A red arrow points to the 'Search' option in the top-left corner.

Campaign Type	Description
Search	Get in front of high-intent customers at the right time on Google Search
Performance Max	Reach audiences across all of Google with a single campaign. See how it works
Display	Reach customers across 3 million sites and apps with engaging creative
Shopping	Showcase your products to shoppers as they explore what to buy
Video	Reach viewers on YouTube and get conversions
App	Drive downloads and grow engagement for your app
Smart	Reach customers with a one-stop solution built for small businesses
Discovery	Run ads on YouTube, Gmail, Discover, and more

Creating a Campaign

- Here is where you will specify the conversion the Campaign should optimize to and report on.

Use these conversion goals for campaign performance optimization

Conversion goals labeled as account default will use data from all of your campaigns to improve your bid strategy and campaign performance

Conversion Goals	Conversion Source	Conversion Actions	Value
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 Purchases (account default)	Website	<u>2 actions</u>	Dynamic (Multiple values avg)

Next You'll Choose Bidding

- We will cover the different bidding options and types in an upcoming lesson. You can always change this.

Use these conversion goals for campaign performance optimization

Conversion goals labeled as account default will use data from all of your campaigns to improve your bid strategy and campaign performance

Conversion Goals	Conversion Source	Conversion Actions	Value
 Engagements (account default)	Website	<u>3 actions</u>	Multiple values
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 Purchases (account default)	Website	<u>2 actions</u>	Dynamic (Multiple values avg)

Campaign Settings

- Uncheck Display Network
- Specify where your ads should run & languages
- We will talk about Audience Segments in a few lessons.
- Turn off Automatically Created Assets for now.
- In “More Settings,” leave things as they are for now.

Campaign settings

To reach the right people, start by defining key settings for your campaign

Networks



Search Network

Ads can appear near Google Search results and other Google sites when people search for terms that are relevant to your keywords

☒ Include Google search partners ⓘ



Display Network

Easy way to get additional conversions at similar or lower costs than Search with unused Search budget.

☒ Include Google Display Network ⓘ

Locations

Select locations to target ⓘ

☐ All countries and territories

☐ France

☒ Enter another location

Targeted locations (1)

United States country

Reach ⓘ ⓘ

322,000,000 ⓘ

🔍 Enter a location to target or exclude

[Advanced search](#)

For example, a country, city, region, or postal code

✓ [Location options](#)

Languages

Select the languages your customers speak. ⓘ

🔍 Start typing or select a language

English ✕

Audience segments

Select audience segments to add to your campaign

Automatically created assets

You can allow Google to help you generate headlines, descriptions, and other assets using your content from your landing page, domain, and ads. Google will provide you with automated tools to customize your assets based on relevance for your keywords. This may improve ad relevance and performance. [Learn more](#)

☐ On: Use my content from my landing page, domain, and ads in combination with assets I provide. Customize assets based on relevance for my keywords ⓘ

☒ Off: Use only assets I provide directly for my ads

⚙️ [More settings](#)

Campaign Settings

NEW: Broad match setting

Campaign Settings → Broad Match Keywords
Recommend leaving off. You'll see why when we cover match types in the next lesson.

Broad match keywords

Broad match keywords work with Smart Bidding to help you reach your campaign goals. Using broad match keywords for your entire campaign ensures consistency and provides access to additional settings, such as brand restrictions. [Learn more about broad match keywords](#)

- ☐ On: Use broad match keywords for your entire campaign
- ☒ Off: Use keyword match types

Cancel

Save

Ad Group & Ads

The next screen will have you specify the keywords you want to target, and then input the ad copy you want to run.

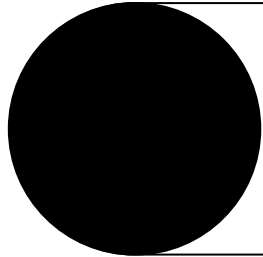
We will cover keyword strategies and ad copy more in-depth shortly.

Lesson Recap

1. Campaigns are where you make a lot of setting decisions, such as budget, bid type, and geography.
2. Ad Groups mostly function as a group of keywords that will all share the same ad copy.
3. We will explore different structure types later in the course.

Lesson 4: Search Queries, Keywords & Match Types

Course Objective 2: How to Do Keyword Research



Susan Wenograd

The journey of this course

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Basic Settings, Ad
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Discover methods for
structuring Ad Groups
and Ad Copy



Objective 3

Understand How the Ads Auction Works

Learn Different
Campaign Types &
Bidding Options



Objective 4

Learn the Tools and Reports to Help Optimize Your Results

Lesson Objectives

1. Learn about how Google matches user search queries to the keywords you choose.
2. Review match types, and how they do/don't control what Google does.
3. The pros/cons of the different match types.

Keywords vs. Queries

Keywords = what you tell Google you want

Search queries = what users actually search

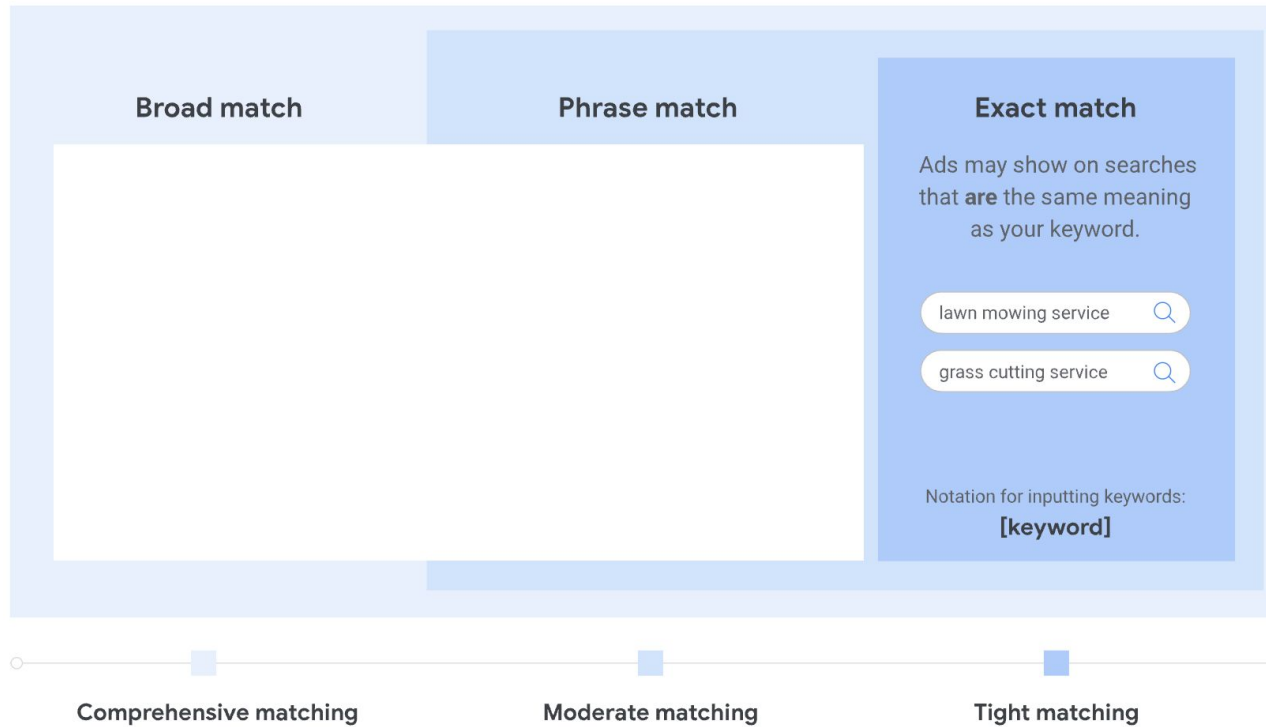
No, they are not the same thing!

How Does Google Match Them?

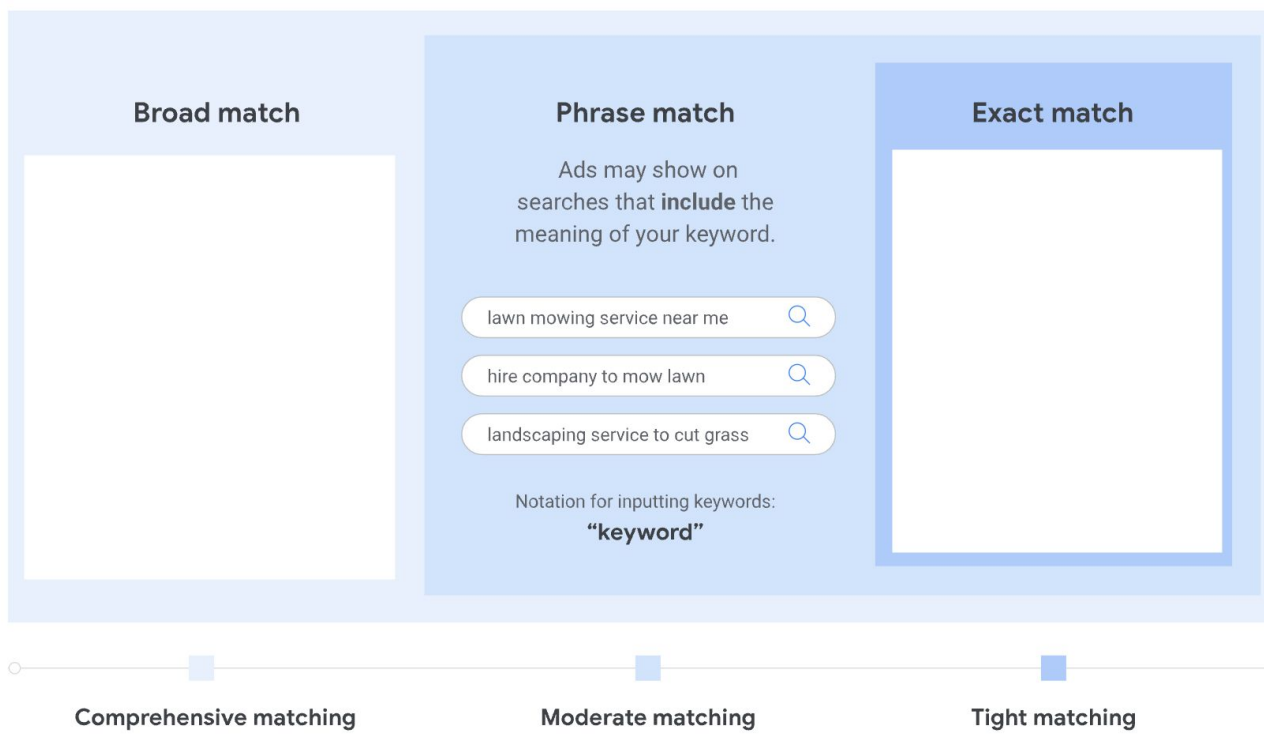
Google does its best to match relevance, but we have guardrails we can use called “match types.”

1. Exact Match
2. Phrase Match
3. Broad Match

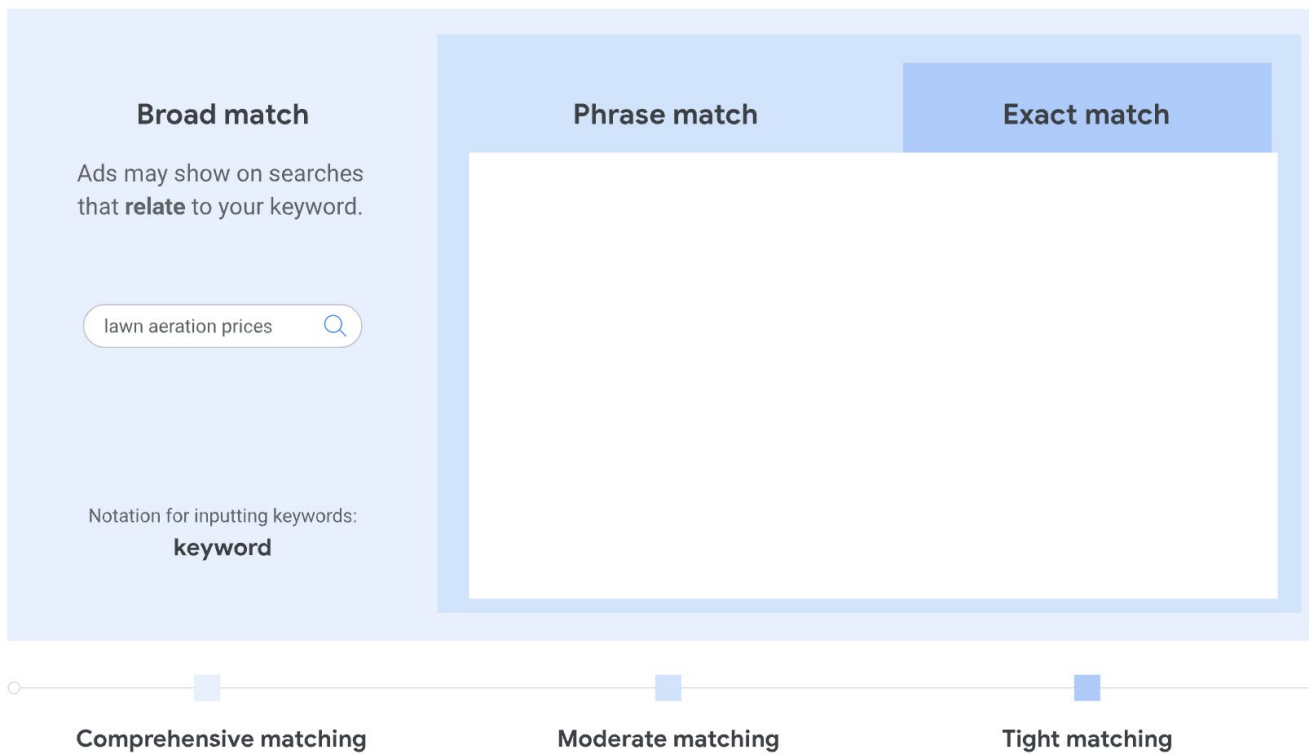
Exact Match



Phrase Match



Broad Match



Pros/Cons

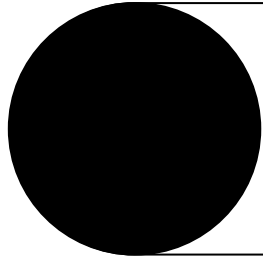
1. Exact = Usually more expensive, but most accurate
2. Phrase = Can still be pricey, will get irrelevant matches, but also good discovery
3. Broad = Cheapest, but must be monitored for wasteful matching

Lesson Recap

1. There are 3 ways to tell Google how to match your keywords to search queries. Going from closest match to loosest: Exact, Phrase and Broad.
2. These all have their benefits and drawbacks. Review these and determine what works best for your budget and goals.

Lesson 5: Grouping Keywords

Course Objective 2: How to Do Keyword Research



Susan Wenograd

Lesson Objectives

1. The most common strategies for account structure.
2. How to think about grouping match types, and what to expect.

Important Mindset Note

Brands can obsess over using exact match and wanting to force it to be used.

Evaluate all decisions with math only - not human logic.

Math. Not principles.

Example:

Exact match version is a \$4 CPC.

vs.

Letting the same query match to Broad match with a \$1 CPC.

Does the exact version convert 4x better than Broad to justify that cost? Use math, not “but exact match should be the most relevant” principle...

Math. Not principles.

Keyword ↓		Max. CPC	CTR	Avg. CPC	Conversion:	Cost / conv.	Conv. value / cost
[d] Exact		\$2.30 	21.19%	\$2.38	16.23	\$12.00	4.99
" " Phrase		\$0.77 	10.88%	\$1.90	20.44	\$12.92	5.18

Basic Keyword Grouping

Would they use the same ad copy?

Same ad group.

Need different ad copy?

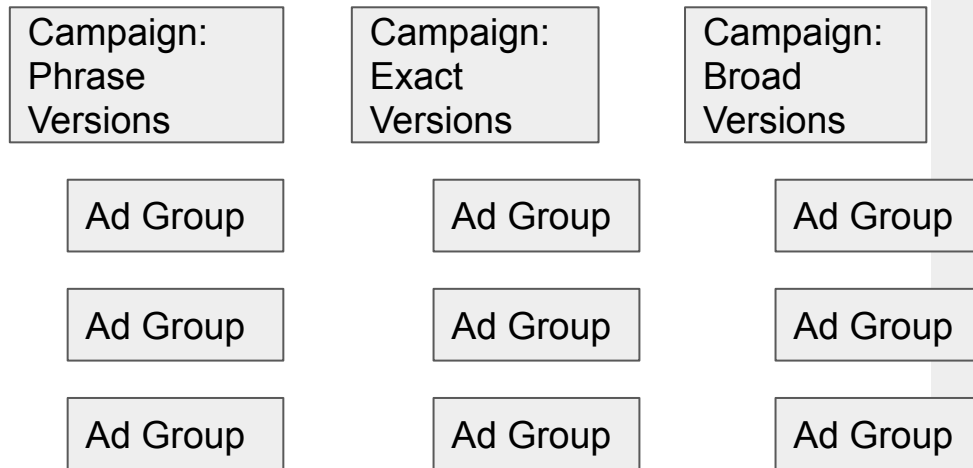
Different ad groups.

Handling Match Types

There are many different schools of thought around this now.

Google's matching has become much more liberal, so there's rarely one "right way."

Option 1: Separate by match type in Campaign



Pro: Tighter budget control

Con: likely to have a lot of queries matching all over

Option 1: Separate by match type in Ad Group

Campaign

Ad Group: Phrase

Ad Group: Exact

Ad Group: Broad

Pro: More streamlined setup with one Campaign

Con: Budget likely to be eaten up by Broad volume

Option 2: Combine match types

Campaign

Ad Group: Theme
with all match types

Ad Group: Theme
with all match types

Ad Group: Theme
with all match types

Pro: More streamlined setup with one Campaign

Con: Budget will be distributed mostly at Google's discretion

Consider the Pros/Cons & Your Needs

1. Do you need/want tight budget control?
2. How much time can you dedicate to implementing negative keywords & analyzing if that's best?

Structure at a Glance

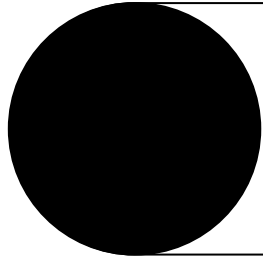
Structure Type	Pros	Cons	When to Use
Match Types By Campaign	Tight control budget allocation if you want that. Increased insight/control over how Google matches search queries.	Check frequently to see if Google is matching terms to Exact/Phrase vs. Broad. You'll be adding a lot of negatives to the Broad campaign often.	You can dedicate the time to keeping the matching as clean as possible.
Match Types by Ad Group	Increased control over how Google matches your search queries by using negatives.	A shared budget at the Campaign level can mean Broad spends most of the money, and not Exact/Phrase.	You don't care how budget is spent, or you don't want to spend time managing/allocating it. All your terms are pretty closely related, and you are ok spending time aggressively adding negatives to Broad ad groups.
All match types in an ad group	No spending time adding a lot of negatives to funnel queries to the desired match type. Easier to "set and forget," especially with automated bidding.	Broad will eat most of your spend, and if Exact/Phrase are more efficient, you can't make sure you're allocating the most spend there.	Terms are all very closely related, and you don't have to manage closely.

Lesson Recap

1. Most accounts are structured one of a few ways.
2. There's no "right" way. It should be done based on considerations like budget, the time you have to manage it.
3. Match types generally play a part in this decision, depending on how much control you want to try and exert over how Google matches queries.

Lesson 6: What is Quality Score

Course Objective 3: How the Ads Auction Works



Susan Wenograd

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Objective 3

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Learn Different
Campaign Types &
Bidding Options



Objective 4

Learn the Tools and Reports to Help Optimize Your Results

Lesson Objectives

1. What is Quality Score?
2. Does it matter?
3. What should you do if your scores are low.

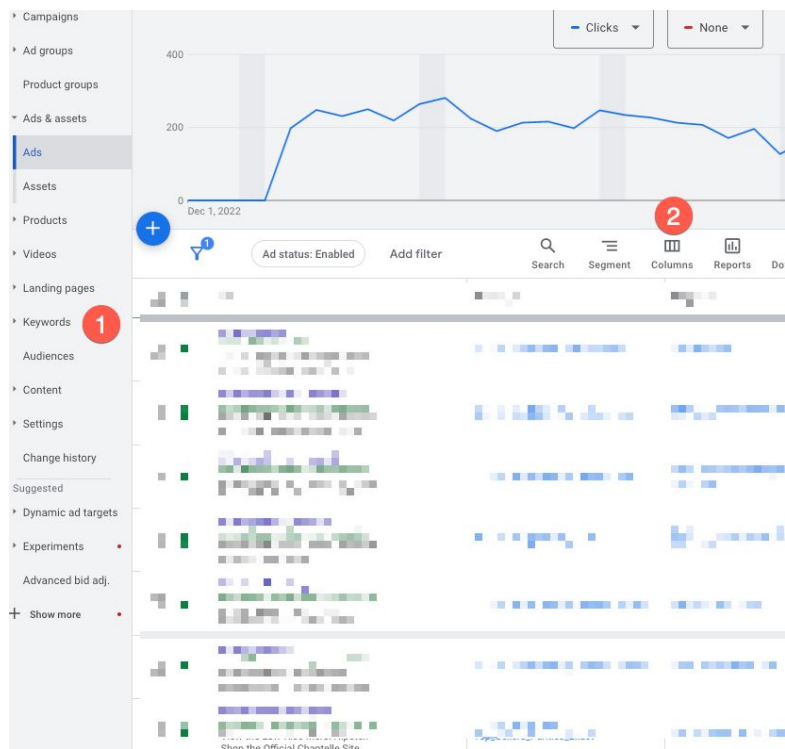
Quality Score

1-10 Scale assigned by Google perception of relevance historically on exact matches.

- Expected CTR
- Ad relevance to user's search
- Landing page experience

Better quality scores = lower CPC, which takes your budget a bit further = more impressions, potentially.

Where to See It

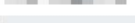
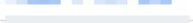
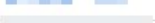


Modify columns for keywords

[+ Custom column](#)

- Performance
 - Viewability
 - Conversions
 - Attribution
 - Attributes
 - Bid simulator
 - Competitive metrics
 - Call details
 - Message details
 - YouTube Earned actions
 - Gmail Metric
 - Quality score
- ☐ Quality Score ☐ Quality Score (hist.) ☐ Exp. CTR ☐ Exp. CTR (hist.)
- ☐ Landing page exp. ☐ Landing page exp. (hist.) ☐ Ad relevance ☐ Ad relevance (hist.)

Where to See It

Keyword	Match type	Campaign	Ad group	Status	Max. CPC	↓ Quality Score
	Exact match	[SRC] 		Eligible	\$3.39 (enhanced) 	10/10
	Exact match	[SRC] 		Eligible	\$2.10 (enhanced) 	10/10
	Exact match	[SRC] 	 Exact	Eligible	\$0.50 (enhanced) 	10/10
	Exact match	[SRC] 	 Exact	Eligible	\$0.50 (enhanced) 	10/10
	Exact match	[SRC] 	 Exact	Eligible	\$0.50 (enhanced) 	10/10
	Exact match	[SRC] 		Eligible	\$2.47 	10/10
	Exact match	[SRC] 		Eligible	\$1.44 	10/10
	Phrase match	[SRC] 		Eligible	\$1.44 	10/10
	Phrase match	[SRC] 		Eligible	\$2.47 	10/10
	Exact match	[SRC] 		Eligible	\$3.21 	10/10

Where to See It

	Quality Score (hist.)	Exp. CTR	Exp. CTR (hist.)	Ad relevance (hist.)	Ad relevance	Landing page exp. (hist.)	Landing page exp.
	10/10	Above average	Above average	Above average	Above average	Above average	Above average
	10/10	Above average	Above average	Above average	Above average	Above average	Above average
	10/10	Above average	Above average	Above average	Above average	Above average	Above average
	10/10	Above average	Above average	Above average	Above average	Above average	Above average
	10/10	Above average	Above average	Above average	Above average	Above average	Above average
	10/10	Above average	Above average	Above average	Above average	Above average	Above average
	10/10	Above average	Above average	Above average	Above average	Above average	Above average
	10/10	Above average	Above average	Above average	Above average	Above average	Above average
	10/10	Above average	Above average	Above average	Above average	Above average	Above average
	10/10	Above average	Above average	Above average	Above average	Above average	Above average

Should You Fixate On This?

- Not an optimization thing. “Check engine light.”
- Focus if not getting impressions.

Addressing Problems

- Tighter ad groups with more relevant copy?
- Keyword only loosely related.
- Landing page testing.

Lesson Recap

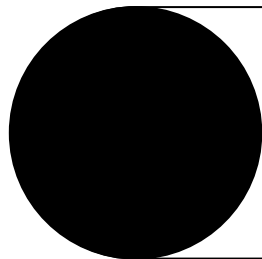
1. Quality Score is a signal from Google so you know how relevant they think you are to the keywords you bid on.
2. Better Quality Score can mean lower CPCs, and higher impression share.
3. This isn't a metric to optimize to or obsess over, but something to keep an eye on.

Assignment

1. Export your keywords and their Quality Scores.
2. Sort by lowest to highest, and take a look at where you might be able to make some improvements.

Lesson 7: Different Bidding Types & How to Choose

Course Objective 3: How the Ads Auction Works



Susan Wenograd

Lesson Objectives

1. Review the 3 main bidding types managers use.
2. Understand the pros and cons of each.
3. How I usually recommend tackling when you're first starting out.

Bidding Background

Google has pushed automated bidding for years now.

Major advances in smarter matching/understanding the past year, but moreso in B2C. B2B can still be a struggle for it.

Bidding Background

Some practitioners refuse to let go of manual bidding, but I encourage you to test it. More than half the time, Google will do better if you help it with things like negative keywords, etc.

There are many ways to bid, but we will cover the 3 most common.

Manual Bidding

Pros

More control over click cost.

You can bid as specifically as each keyword.

Cons

All clicks are “equal” - even user more/less likely to convert, they are equal cost/worth.

Conversion Cost Bidding: CPA or ROAS

Pros

Costs are more closely tied to outcomes desired.

Google can sometimes “bet high” and have ridiculously high CPCs show up.

Cons

Target CPA might limit volume you get.

If you don't get a lot of conversions, Google's also never learns how to target or bid well.

Conversion Bidding: Volume

Pros

Costs are more closely tied to outcomes desired.

Google can sometimes “bet high” and have ridiculously high CPCs show up.

Cons

High volume could mean pushing limits on cost comfort.

Bidding at a Glance

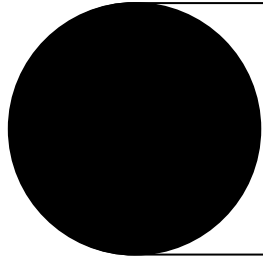
Bid Type	Pros	Cons	When to Use
Manual	Tight control over CPC	Doesn't account for actual account goal of conversions, and the relative value of click based on user.	Automated costs just too high. Usually recommend this for brand campaigns, as well.
CPA/ROAS Goals	Better chance of hitting your goal range for CPA or ROAS	Can limit volume. Goal may be too low for reality of auction, so you get no traction.	Usually recommend running max. Conversions first to see what this average is. With that data, Google will recommend what you set this to. If you do it without that data, you may never get off the ground because you set it too low.
Maximize Conversions	Google learns and usually will optimize cost over time.	Clicks can be crazy-expensive. Sacrifice cost efficiency for volume.	New campaigns that need to get data for Google. Once you have benchmarks, usually move off this to a CPA/ROAS Goal to keep it steady.

Lesson Recap

1. The 3 main bidding types are manually managing the Max CPCs, setting a goal CPA or ROAS for Google to optimize to, or having Google just get as many conversions as possible, regardless of their cost.
2. The main issue with starting by managing costs tightly at the start is Google needs a lot of data to optimize and learn. Restricting that learning can result in an account that struggles to get off the ground.
3. For new accounts, usually recommend → max. Conversions → goal CPA/ROAS.
4. If Google doesn't get enough conversions, it won't learn, and you may need to change to Manual CPC.

Lesson 8: Optimizing Using Search Query Reports

Course Objective 4: Learn the Tools and Reports to Help Optimize Your Results



Susan Wenograd

The journey of this course

Objective 1

Confidently Navigate the Google Ads Interface

Basic Settings, Ad
Options, and
Account Structure



Objective 2

How to Do Keyword Research

Discover methods for
structuring Ad Groups
and Ad Copy



Objective 3

Understand How the Ads Auction Works

Learn Different
Campaign Types &
Bidding Options



Objective 4

Learn the Tools and Reports to Help Optimize Your Results

Lesson Objectives

1. How to see what user search queries your keywords are being matched for.
2. Using this report to find negative keywords, and other keywords to add to your account.
3. Using it to see how Google is matching queries to your account, and whether it's making mistakes.

Where Search Query Reports Live

Search term	Match type	Added/Excluded	Campaign	Ad group	CTR	↓ Impr.	Avg. CPC	Cost	Campaign type	Conversion:	Cost / conv.	Conv. value / cost
Search term 1	Exact match	✓ Added	Campaign 1	Ad group 1	35.77%	6,793	\$1.55	\$3,759.55	Search	373.89	\$10.06	11.87
Search term 2	Exact match	✓ Added	Campaign 2	Ad group 2	42.13%	6,167	\$1.94	\$5,031.31	Search	395.73	\$12.71	9.28
Search term 3	Exact match	✓ Added	Campaign 3	Ad group 3	36.98%	1,225	\$2.12	\$959.91	Search	58.30	\$16.46	6.08
Search term 4	Exact match	✓ Added	Campaign 4	Ad group 4	31.19%	1,135	\$1.01	\$357.87	Search	57.01	\$6.28	16.70
Search term 5	Exact match (close variant)	✓ Added	Campaign 5	Ad group 5	38.31%	402	\$1.17	\$180.59	Search	5.00	\$36.12	3.82
Search term 6	Exact match	✓ Added	Campaign 6	Ad group 6	32.30%	161	\$1.59	\$82.48	Search	3.85	\$21.42	5.91
Search term 7	Exact match	✓ Added	Campaign 7	Ad group 7	24.65%	142	\$1.36	\$47.43	Search	2.50	\$18.97	4.26
Search term 8	Exact match (close variant)	None	Campaign 8	Ad group 8	48.81%	84	\$2.37	\$97.17	Search	2.00	\$48.59	3.50
Search term 9	Phrase match (close variant)	None	Campaign 9	Ad group 9	0.00%	81	—	\$0.00	Search	0.00	\$0.00	0.00
Search term 10	Exact match	✓ Added	Campaign 10	Ad group 10	35.90%	78	\$1.60	\$44.80	Search	0.00	\$0.00	0.00

Optimizing: Matching

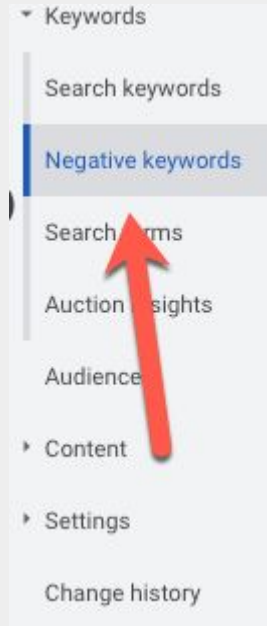
Keywords		Add filter		Segment Columns Download E									
Search keywords		Search term	Match type	Added/Excluded	Campaign	Ad group	Avg. CPV	Impr.	Interacti	Interaction rate	Avg. cost	Cost	
Negative keywords													
Search terms			Exact match	✓ Added	[SPC] BPH GG I Bras - EYC Bras		—	6,167	2,598 clicks	42.13%	\$1.94	\$5,031.31	
Auction insights			Exact match	✓ Added	[Sf		—	6,793	2,430 clicks	35.77%	\$1.55	\$3,759.55	
Audiences			Exact match	✓ Added	[Sf		—	1,225	453 clicks	36.98%	\$2.12	\$959.91	
Content			Exact match	✓ Added	[Sf		—	1,135	354 clicks	31.19%	\$1.01	\$357.87	
Settings			Exact match (close variant)	✓ Added	[Sf		—	402	154 clicks	38.31%	\$1.17	\$180.59	
Change history			Exact match	✓ Added	[Sf		—	161	52 clicks	32.30%	\$1.59	\$82.48	
Suggested			Exact match (close variant)	None	[Sf		—	84	41 clicks	48.81%	\$2.37	\$97.17	
Dynamic ad targets			Exact match (close variant)	None	[Sf		—	77	36 clicks	46.75%	\$2.10	\$75.78	
Experiments			Exact match	✓ Added	[Sf	- Brand	—	142	35 clicks	24.65%	\$1.36	\$47.43	
Advanced bid adj.			Exact match	✓ Added	[Sf		—	78	28 clicks	35.90%	\$1.60	\$44.80	

Does the search query match correctly? Does it match consistently with where it gets the best results?

Optimizing: Negative Keywords

If not, or you see queries you don't want to show for, add them as negative keywords.

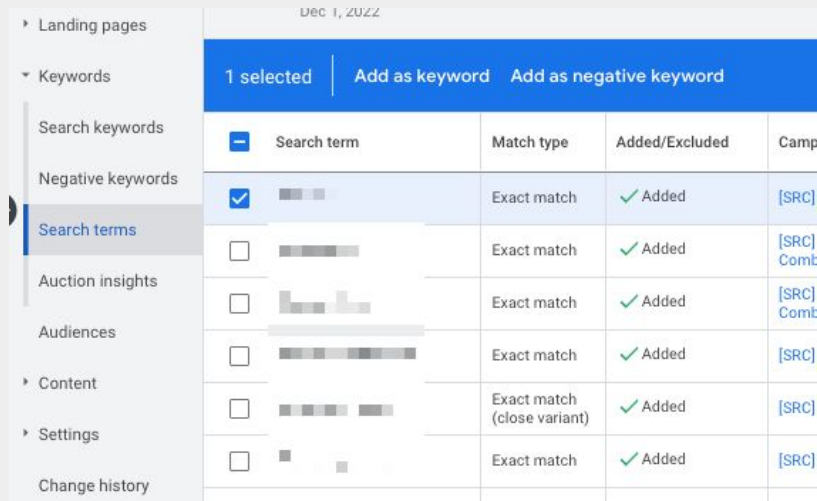
- Any match type
- Account, Campaign, or Ad Group level option
- Use broad for whole categories you want to cancel (example: "free")



Optimizing: Keyword Discovery

Seeing good, new keywords to add?

Check box to add, but it will add where it matched. This may not match your account structure.



The screenshot shows the Google Ads Keyword Discovery interface. On the left is a sidebar with navigation options: Landing pages, Keywords (expanded), Search keywords, Negative keywords, Search terms (highlighted), Auction insights, Audiences, Content, Settings, and Change history. The main area displays a table of search terms for the date Dec 1, 2022. At the top of the table, it says '1 selected' and provides buttons to 'Add as keyword' or 'Add as negative keyword'. The table has five columns: Search term, Match type, Added/Excluded, and Campaign. The first row is selected, showing a search term with a blue bar chart, 'Exact match' type, 'Added' status, and a '[SRC]' link. The following four rows are unselected, each showing a search term with a grey bar chart, 'Exact match' type, 'Added' status, and a '[SRC]' link. The fifth row shows a search term with a grey bar chart, 'Exact match (close variant)' type, 'Added' status, and a '[SRC]' link. The final row is unselected, showing a search term with a grey bar chart, 'Exact match' type, 'Added' status, and a '[SRC]' link.

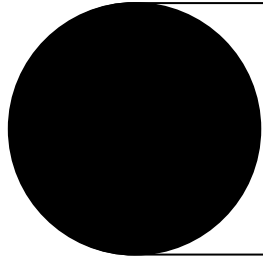
Dec 1, 2022				
1 selected Add as keyword Add as negative keyword				
☐	Search term	Match type	Added/Excluded	Camp
☒		Exact match	✓ Added	[SRC]
☐		Exact match	✓ Added	[SRC] Comt
☐		Exact match	✓ Added	[SRC] Comt
☐		Exact match	✓ Added	[SRC]
☐		Exact match (close variant)	✓ Added	[SRC]
☐		Exact match	✓ Added	[SRC]

Lesson Recap

1. The search query report is one of the best tools you have to help Google be more efficient and learn faster.
2. Use it to check for:
 - a. Words you want to exclude ever showing for.
 - b. See how Google matches queries to your account, and ensure it's happening the best way possible.

Lesson 9: Optimizing Using Auction Insights

Course Objective 4: Learn the Tools and Reports to Help Optimize Your Results



Susan Wenograd

Lesson Objectives

1. Where the Auction Insights report is.
2. What information it contains.
3. How to use it to understand the auction and competitor strategies over time.

What is the Auction Insight Report?

Overview of how you're doing vs. the competitors in your auction space.

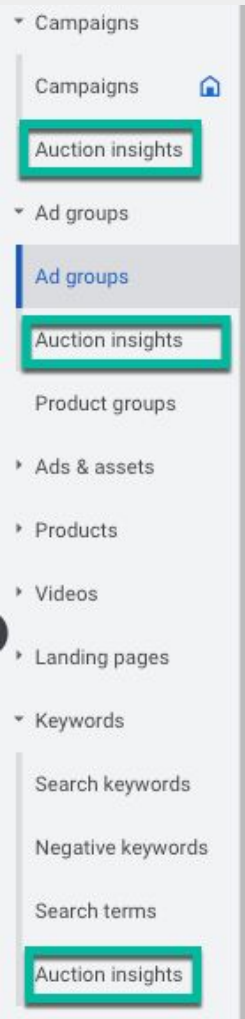
Useful for: understanding marketplace changes, your general competitiveness, and who you're really up against.

Display URL domain	↓ Impression share	Overlap rate	Position above rate	Top of page rate	Abs. Top of page rate	Outranking share
You	70.20%	—	—	97.30%	92.04%	—
amazon.com	30.13%	39.86%	1.48%	89.96%	2.72%	69.79%
mec 	< 10%	6.94%	9.56%	93.58%	15.02%	69.73%
ori 	< 10%	10.92%	12.08%	89.89%	16.30%	69.27%

Where It Lives

Pull at Campaign, Ad Group, or Keyword level.

Keep in mind, if data is too small it might not give much insight, so you may want to start at a higher level like Campaign.



Ways to Use It:

Competitors

Display URL domain	↓ Impression share	Overlap rate	Position above rate	Top of page rate	Abs. Top of page rate	Outranking share
You						
amazon.com						
macys.com						
nordstrom.com						

Ways to Use It: Marketplace Changes

Hit Segment → Time and choose the segments to look at. This is a great way to see changes over time.

- Here's an example of quarterly for last year.
- We can clearly see Amazon started getting more aggressive and then backed off again.
- Coincided with rising CPCs, and this showed us evidence of why.

Display URL domain	↓ Impression share	Overlap rate	Position above rate	Top of page rate	Abs. Top of page rate	Outranking share
amazon.com	26.42%	27.78%	5.05%	60.08%	5.87%	83.96%
Q1 2022	12.78%	14.35%	11.13%	49.72%	10.64%	69.10%
Q2 2022	34.84%	35.54%	7.60%	57.37%	9.01%	80.37%
Q3 2022	30.39%	31.57%	3.39%	59.35%	3.74%	88.36%
Q4 2022	15.76%	17.79%	1.30%	71.63%	0.70%	88.01%

Optimizing: How Often

Varies based on account size/amount of data, but generally:

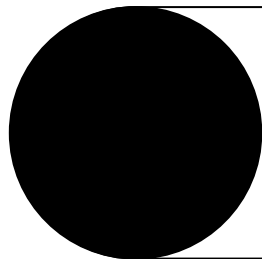
- Check search queries once a week.
- Watch costs/bidding/etc 2x a week.
- Check Auction Insights monthly and quarterly.

Lesson Recap

1. The Auction Insights report shows you who you are mostly up against in the marketplace.
2. It will show you proportions of how often you show, and where, relative to other bidders.
3. You can look at this report in segments of time, which can unearth larger changes in the competition over time.

Lesson 10: Using Audiences for Deeper Insight

Course Objective 5: Learn the Tools and Reports to Help Optimize Your Results



Susan Wenograd

Lesson Objectives

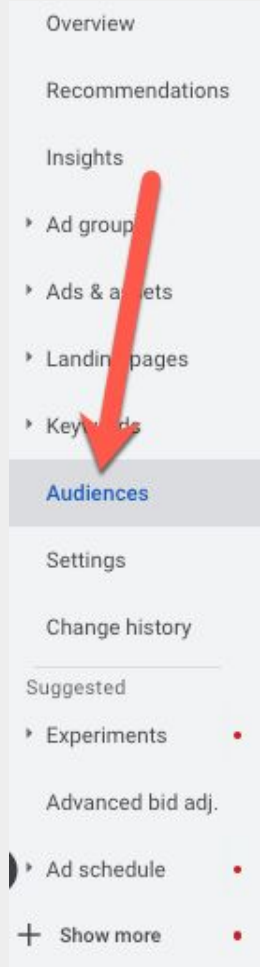
1. What Audiences are.
2. How to add them to Campaigns or Ad Groups to limit reach, or see insights.

Google Audiences

- Google has pre-made audience segments you can apply to your campaigns or ad groups.
- You can also add your own, like website visitors.
- These can be done as Observation or as Targeting.
- Both ways can be used to your advantage!

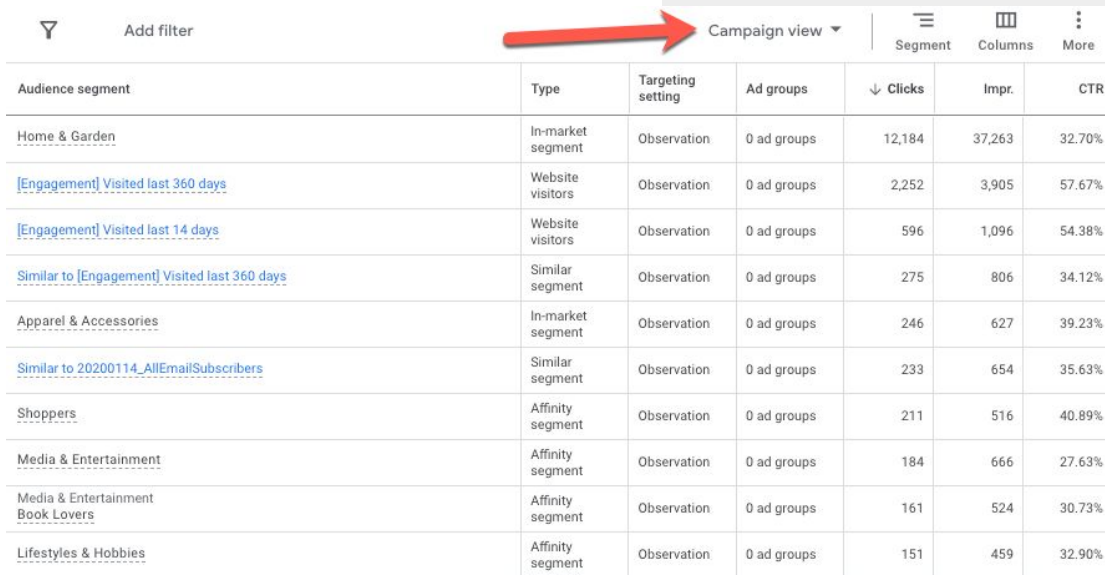
How to Apply Them

Navigate to the Campaign or Ad Group you want to use them on → Audiences



How to Apply Them

Expand the top table to see Audiences that already are applied (if any). Note you can toggle between Campaign and Ad Group views on the right



The screenshot shows a Google Ads interface with a table of audience segments. A red arrow points to the 'Campaign view' dropdown menu in the top right corner. The table has columns for Audience segment, Type, Targeting setting, Ad groups, Clicks, Impr., and CTR. The first row is 'Home & Garden' with 12,184 clicks and 32.70% CTR. The second row is '[Engagement] Visited last 360 days' with 2,252 clicks and 57.67% CTR. The third row is '[Engagement] Visited last 14 days' with 596 clicks and 54.38% CTR. The fourth row is 'Similar to [Engagement] Visited last 360 days' with 275 clicks and 34.12% CTR. The fifth row is 'Apparel & Accessories' with 246 clicks and 39.23% CTR. The sixth row is 'Similar to 20200114_AllEmailSubscribers' with 233 clicks and 35.63% CTR. The seventh row is 'Shoppers' with 211 clicks and 40.89% CTR. The eighth row is 'Media & Entertainment' with 184 clicks and 27.63% CTR. The ninth row is 'Media & Entertainment Book Lovers' with 161 clicks and 30.73% CTR. The tenth row is 'Lifestyles & Hobbies' with 151 clicks and 32.90% CTR.

Audience segment	Type	Targeting setting	Ad groups	Clicks	Impr.	CTR
Home & Garden	In-market segment	Observation	0 ad groups	12,184	37,263	32.70%
[Engagement] Visited last 360 days	Website visitors	Observation	0 ad groups	2,252	3,905	57.67%
[Engagement] Visited last 14 days	Website visitors	Observation	0 ad groups	596	1,096	54.38%
Similar to [Engagement] Visited last 360 days	Similar segment	Observation	0 ad groups	275	806	34.12%
Apparel & Accessories	In-market segment	Observation	0 ad groups	246	627	39.23%
Similar to 20200114_AllEmailSubscribers	Similar segment	Observation	0 ad groups	233	654	35.63%
Shoppers	Affinity segment	Observation	0 ad groups	211	516	40.89%
Media & Entertainment	Affinity segment	Observation	0 ad groups	184	666	27.63%
Media & Entertainment Book Lovers	Affinity segment	Observation	0 ad groups	161	524	30.73%
Lifestyles & Hobbies	Affinity segment	Observation	0 ad groups	151	459	32.90%

How to Use the Info

Have a segment doing really well on Exact or Phrase?

Set up a Campaign filtered to that segment, and test Broad Match with them. Find new terms, and see if the cheaper CPC and better reach get you more conversions.

Audience segment	npr.	CTR	Avg. CPC	Cost	Conv. rate	↓ Conver	Cost / conv.
Shoppers Shopping Enthusiasts	587	30.94%	\$1.13	\$556.23	3.05%	15.00	\$37.08
Lifestyles & Hobbies Nightlife Enthusiasts	224	38.07%	\$1.17	\$543.63	2.90%	13.50	\$40.27
All Site Visitors - 30 days	427	38.64%	\$1.96	\$323.28	5.66%	9.33	\$34.64
Shoppers Luxury Shoppers	171	34.42%	\$1.37	\$551.55	2.29%	9.24	\$59.72
Media & Entertainment TV Lovers	777	33.37%	\$1.26	\$747.19	1.43%	8.50	\$87.95
Lifestyles & Hobbies Pet Lovers	343	34.92%	\$1.54	\$720.30	1.71%	8.00	\$90.04
Beauty & Wellness Beauty Mavens	071	35.20%	\$1.20	\$452.31	2.12%	8.00	\$56.54
Travel	686	33.99%	\$1.21	\$691.50	1.31%	7.50	\$92.20
Technology > Technophiles Home Automation Enthusiasts	764	37.17%	\$1.36	\$387.20	2.46%	7.00	\$55.31
Sports & Fitness Sports Fans	776	30.74%	\$1.54	\$838.99	1.19%	6.50	\$129.08

How to Use the Info

Have a segment doing poorly?
Set them as an excluded audience

Audience segment	npr.	CTR	Avg. CPC	Cost	Conv. rate	↓ Conver	Cost / conv.
Shoppers Shopping Enthusiasts	587	30.94%	\$1.13	\$556.23	3.05%	15.00	\$37.08
Lifestyles & Hobbies Nightlife Enthusiasts	224	38.07%	\$1.17	\$543.63	2.90%	13.50	\$40.27
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Lifestyles & Hobbies Pet Lovers	343	34.92%	\$1.54	\$720.30	1.71%	8.00	\$90.04
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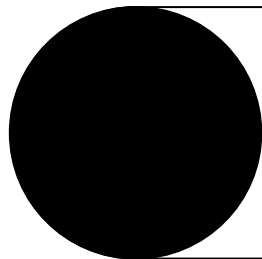
Optimizing Audiences

- Observation: Are there audiences that don't do well? Add them as exclusions so you don't pay money for their clicks.
- Targeting: Take your best-performers, make a Campaign Targeted to them and run Broad Match to learn more!

Lesson Recap

1. Google has many possibly-useful audience types that relate to your vertical.
2. Add as many as you'd like for Observation to learn if there are particularly profitable segments for you.
3. Add your own audiences, like previous website visitors to learn more about how these segments behave after visiting you.
4. Exclude poor performers, and see how far and how much you can squeeze from the high performers!

Course Wrap-Up



Susan Wenograd

Before You Spend a Dime

1. Choose & set up your conversion method.
2. Calculate what costs make sense for your customer for CPA/ROAS.
 - a. Consider LTV
3. Consider your Campaign structure
 - a. Do you need separate Campaigns to control budget allocation?
 - b. How do you want to handle keyword match types?
4. Decide on bidding to start with.
 - a. Do you get a lot of conversions Google can work with pretty quickly?

After You Launch

1. Where are your costs netting out?
 - a. If they're good, switch to Goal ROAS or CPA.
 - b. If they're too high, check your matching to make sure there isn't waste, and your Conversion Rate to see if maybe your site/landing page has problems.
2. Review the Search Query Report weekly.
 - a. Make sure you're not showing for anything you don't want to be.
 - b. Keep an eye out for winning keywords to add.
3. Review Audiences on Observation.
 - a. Any exclusions to make?
 - b. Any winners to try and scale with Broad match?
4. Review Auction Insights monthly/quarterly
 - a. Any increased competitive pressure to be aware of?
 - b. Any competitors added/dropped out?